



restaurant

DROPOUT

SPRING RECIPES 2025



THIS WEEK'S MENU

Caesar Salad with Bouillon Crouton

romaine lettuce, caesar dressing, parmesan, lemon, freshly ground black pepper, bouillon croutons, grilled chicken breast

Arayes (Spiced Meat-Stuffed Pitas) with Tomato Cucumber Salad

spiced meat filling, chopped herbs, fluffy pita, grape tomatoes, Persian cucumbers, olive oil, tzatziki, silky hummus

Lemon Oregano Chicken Skewers with Sun-Dried Tomato Greens

lemon oregano-marinated chicken skewers, kale, romaine, grape tomatoes, sun-dried tomato vinaigrette, fluffy pitas

Parmesan Chicken Cutlets with Sun-Dried Tomato Caesar Slaw

parmesan-crusted chicken cutlets, kale, romaine, sun-dried tomato vinaigrette, Casey's Caesar dressing, shaved parmesan, lemon

Sun-Dried Tomato Gnocchi with Parmesan Meatballs

sun-dried tomato velouté, parmesan, grape tomatoes, potato gnocchi, parmesan meatballs, parsley, freshly ground black pepper



GROCERY LIST

Produce

- Shallot (2)⁵
- Garlic (12 cloves)¹²³⁴⁵
- Lemon (6)¹²³⁴
- Grape Tomatoes; like Cherubs (10 oz)²³⁴⁵
- Persian or Mini Cucumbers (6)²³
- Lacinato Kale (1 bunch)³⁴
- Romaine Hearts (3)¹³⁴
- Dill (1 bunch)²³
- Parsley(1 bunch)²³⁴⁵

Shelf-Stable Goods

- Sun-Dried Tomatoes (7 oz)¹³⁴⁵
- Chickpeas/Garbanzo Beans (15 oz can)¹²³⁴
- Panko Breadcrumbs (2/3 cup)⁴⁵
- Chicken or Vegetable Stock (1 ½+ cups)⁵
- Potato Gnocchi (16 oz)⁵
- Better Than Bouillon (1 Tbsp)¹⁴
- Capers (2 Tbsp + brine)¹⁴
- Tomato Paste (1 Tbsp)³⁴

Bakery

- French Bread Loaf (16 oz)¹⁴

Eggs & Dairy

- Eggs (2)⁴⁵
- Greek Yogurt (1 cup)²³

Cheese

- Parmesan (8 oz)¹³⁴⁵

Suggested Proteins

- 3 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts¹³⁴
- Ground Meat | Zoe's Recommendation:
Ground Chicken (1 lb)²⁵

KEY

¹ = Caesar Salad

² = Arayes

³ = Lemon Oregano Skewers

⁴ = Parmesan Chicken Cutlets

⁵ = Sun-Dried Tomato Pasta

*=rollover ingredient



ESSENTIALS

& TIME SAVERS

Essentials

Fats

- Olive Oil¹²³⁴⁵
- Neutral Oil¹³⁴
- Salted Butter⁵

Acids & Vinegars

- Red Wine Vinegar³⁴

Spices & Aromatics

- Black Pepper¹²³⁴⁵
- Dried Oregano¹³⁴
- Cumin¹²³⁴
- Chicken Bouillon Paste¹⁴
- Red Pepper Flakes²
- Onion Powder²⁵
- Garlic Powder²⁵
- Cinnamon²

Other

- Kosher Salt¹²³⁴⁵
- Unbleached or All-Purpose Flour²³⁴⁵
- Instant Yeast²³
- Honey²³⁴
- White Cane Sugar¹²³
- Tahini¹²³⁴
- Dijon Mustard¹³⁴
- Soy Sauce or Tamari¹⁴
- Baking Soda¹²³⁴
- Worcestershire Sauce¹³

Tools

- 2 (8-inch) Wooden or Metal Skewers

Time Savers

Refrigerated

- Pre-Peeled Garlic
 - 1 bulb of Garlic
- Tzatziki
 - 2 Persian Cucumbers
 - 2 cups Full-Fat Greek Yogurt
 - 4 Garlic cloves
 - 1 Lemon
- Hummus
 - Chickpeas
 - 1 Garlic clove
 - 1 Lemon
 - Baking Soda

Bakery

- Pita
 - Instant Yeast

KEY

¹ = Caesar Salad

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Red = Subtract if using Time Saver



PREP LIST



KEY

¹ = Caesar Salad

² = Arayes

³ = Lemon Oregano Skewers

⁴ = Parmesan Chicken Cutlets

⁵ = Sun-Dried Tomato Pasta

 = used in "prepped ingredient"

 = estimated time

Green = keep out during prep

- Prepare Fluffy Pita Dough (see PDF 'Fluffy Pita')²³
- Prep Produce [ 35 minutes]
 - Romaine (3 hearts; chop to your liking & wash)¹³⁴
 - Lacinato Kale (1 bunch; remove stems, thinly slice, & wash)³⁴
 - Lemon (3; slice into wedges¹²⁴  | 3; slice in half for juicing )
 - Persian Cucumber (2; grate into a clean towel  | 4; cut into bite-sized pieces)²³
 - Herbs
 - Dill (1 bunch)² 
 - Parsley (1 bunch)²⁵ 
 - Garlic (12 cloves; peel) 
 - Shallot (1; finely dice [meatballs] | 1; thinly slice or dice [velouté]) 
- Prepare Sun-Dried Tomato Velouté (see PDF 'Sun-Dried Tomato Velouté')⁵

CLEANING BREAK

- Grate Parmesan¹⁴⁵ 
- Prepare Bouillon Crouton (see PDF 'Bouillon Crouton')¹⁴
- Shape Fluffy Pita (see PDF 'Fluffy Pita' step 3)²³
- Prepare Sauces [ 55 minutes]
 - Silky Hummus (see PDF 'Silky Hummus')²³ 
 - Sun-Dried Tomato Vinaigrette (see PDF 'Sun-Dried Tomato Vinaigrette')³⁴
 - Lemon Oregano Marinade (see PDF 'Lemon Oregano Marinade')¹³
 - Tzatziki (see PDF 'Tzatziki')²³
 - Casey's Caesar Dressing (see PDF 'Casey's Caesar Dressing')¹⁴
- Prepare Fluffy Pita (see PDF 'Fluffy Pita' step 3)²³
- Prepare Parmesan Meatballs (see PDF 'Parmesan Meatballs')⁵ [ 20 minutes]

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP

- Chicken Breasts (1 large; diced into 1 ½" pieces³ | 2 large; sliced in half, lengthwise¹⁴ [store breasts separately])
- ½ lb Ground Meat²
 - Store proteins in airtight bags in the freezer; The night before intended use, transfer to the refrigerator to thaw overnight



GRILLED CHICKEN CAESAR SALAD WITH BOUILLON CROUTON

ADAPTED FROM “WHAT CAN I BRING” BY CASEY ELSASS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Lemon Oregano Marinade (Page 6)¹³

Casey's Caesar Dressing (Page 9)¹⁴

Bouillon Croutons (Page 10)¹⁴

Lemon Oregano Grilled Chicken

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast,
sliced in half (lengthwise)

Kosher Salt

1/2 batch Lemon Oregano Marinade

Neutral, High-Smoke Point Oil, *for cooking*

Caesar Salad

2 Romaine Hearts, cut into bite-sized pieces

1/3 cup Casey's Caesar Dressing, plus more to taste

4 oz Parmesan Cheese, shaved & grated

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

1/2 Lemon, cut into wedges, for serving

3/4 batch of Bouillon Croutons, for serving

Instructions

At least 30 minutes before cooking...

Marinate Chicken

1. Place the **chicken breast** in a small bowl and add a generous **pinch of salt**. Mix well. Stir in the **lemon oregano marinade**, fully coating the chicken, and let it rest at room temperature for 30 minutes.

Hot Tip: For a more concentrated flavor, cover the marinated chicken with plastic wrap and refrigerate for up to 4 hours (the longer, the better).

Prepare the Chicken & Prepare Salad

1. Preheat your grill to 400°F.
2. Once the grill is preheated, lightly coat the grill grates with a **neutral, high-smoke point oil**, and place the marinated chicken directly onto the grates. Cook for 11-12 minutes, flipping halfway. In the meantime, prepare the salad.
3. In a large bowl, toss the **romaine** and **Caesar dressing** until coated. Take a taste and decide if you need another tablespoon of dressing.
4. Use a vegetable peeler to shave about **half the parmesan** in long strips directly into the bowl, then switch to a rasp* grater to grate the rest.
5. Toss once or twice to make sure the cheese gets evenly distributed, then add a ton of good cracks of **black pepper**.
6. Remove the chicken from the grill and let it rest for 4-5 minutes, before slicing.
7. Plate the salad and place the sliced chicken directly on top. Serve immediately with **lemon wedges** for squeezing, and topped with **bouillon croutons**.

*A “rasp” grater is a generic term for a microplane. Since we prepped the cheese beforehand, use a **generous handful of grated parmesan** for this step.

ARAYES (SPICED-MEAT STUFFED PITA)

WITH TOMATO & CUCUMBER SALAD

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Fluffy Pita (Page 11)²³

Tzatziki (Page 12)²³

Silky Hummus (Page 8)²³

Spiced Meat Filling

½ lb Ground Meat (like Chicken, Pork, or Beef)

1 Tbsp Chopped Dill

1 Tbsp Chopped Parsley

1 Tbsp Olive Oil

Juice of ½ a Lemon

1 tsp Ground Cumin

1 tsp Kosher Salt

½ tsp Garlic Powder (i.e., Granulated Garlic)

½ tsp Onion Powder (i.e., Granulated Onion)

¼ tsp Crushed Red Chili Flakes

¼ tsp Freshly Ground Black Pepper

A pinch of Cinnamon

Arayes

2 Fluffy Pitas

Spiced Meat Filling

Olive Oil, *for brushing & cooking*

Tomato Cucumber Salad & Accompaniments

8 Grape Tomatoes, sliced in half

2 Persian Cucumbers, cut into bite-sized pieces

1 tsp Chopped Parsley

1 tsp Chopped Dill

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Juice of ¼ Lemon

Olive Oil

Tzatziki, *for dipping*

Silky Hummus, *for dipping*

Instructions

Assemble the Arayes

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
2. In a mixing bowl, combine all **spiced meat filling ingredients**. Stir until well combined.
3. Wrap **fluffy pitas** in a slightly damp paper towel and microwave for 15-20 seconds—this will help ease the process of creating a pocket. Cut each fluffy pita in half and spread the meat filling evenly in the pita pockets.
4. Brush the outside of each stuffed pita with **olive oil** and set aside.
5. Heat a small glug of olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Place the stuffed pita in the preheated skillet and cook on both sides for 2 to 3 minutes, or until toasted and golden brown. Finish searing with the meat side facing down for 1 minute.
6. Transfer the arayes to a wire rack-lined sheet tray and bake for 4-5 minutes, or until the meat filling is fully cooked.

Hot Tip: While the arayes are baking, *prepare the Tomato Cucumber Salad*.

Prepare the Tomato Cucumber Salad & Plate

1. In a small mixing bowl, combine **tomatoes, cucumbers, parsley, dill, a pinch of salt, black pepper, lemon juice**, and enough **olive oil** to lightly coat everything. Stir until well combined and set aside.
2. Plate the cooked arayes with the tomato and cucumber salad on the side and serve with a dollop of **tzatziki** and **hummus** for dipping.

LEMON OREGANO CHICKEN SKEWERS WITH HUMMUS & SUN-DRIED TOMATO GREENS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Lemon Oregano Marinade (Page 6)¹³

Fluffy Pita (Page 11)²³

Sun-Dried Tomato Vinaigrette (Page 7)³⁴

Silky Hummus (Page 8)²³

Tzatziki (Page 12)²³

Chicken Skewers

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast,
diced into 1 ½ to 2" cubes

Kosher Salt

½ batch (or remaining) Lemon Oregano Marinade

2 x 12" Skewers (Wooden or Metal)

Sun-Dried Tomato Greens & Accompaniments

2 Fluffy Pitass

Thinly sliced Lacinato Kale

Thinly sliced Romaine Lettuce

8 Grape Tomatoes, sliced in half

2 Persian Cucumbers, sliced into bite-sized pieces

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Sun-Dried Tomato Vinaigrette, *to taste*

Silky Hummus, *for serving*

Tzatziki, *for serving (optional)*

Instructions

At least 30 minutes before cooking...

Marinate Chicken

1. Place the diced **chicken breast** in a small bowl and add a generous **pinch of salt**. Mix well. Stir in the **lemon oregano marinade**, fully coating the chicken, and let it rest at room temperature for 30 minutes.

Hot Tip: For a more concentrated flavor, cover the marinated chicken and refrigerate for up to 4 hours (the longer, the better).

Reheat the Pita & Assemble the Skewers

1. Preheat your oven to 450°F.
2. Wrap the **fluffy pitass** in aluminum foil and place them directly in the oven to reheat—set a timer for 15 minutes.
3. Thread the **marinated chicken** onto both **skewers** (about 8 to 9 pieces per skewer).
4. Place the chicken skewers on a baking sheet topped with a wire rack and bake for 13-14 minutes, flipping halfway.
5. Remove the fluffy pitass from the oven and set aside (*keep them wrapped in foil to stay warm*).
6. Switch your oven temperature/setting to broil and finish cooking the chicken skewers for about 2 minutes, or until slightly charred and the internal temperature reaches 165°F.
7. Transfer the chicken skewers to a plate and allow them to rest for 5 minutes before serving.

Prepare the Sun-Dried Tomato Greens

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine **kale**, **lettuce**, **tomatoes**, **cucumbers**, a **pinch of salt**, and **black pepper**. Toss until well combined, then add enough **sun-dried tomato vinaigrette** to coat everything. Toss well and set aside.
2. In your final serving bowls or plates, spoon a generous spoonful of **hummus** onto each plate.
3. Plate the sun-dried tomato greens to the side of the hummus and top each plate with a chicken skewer. Cut the warm pita into quarters and serve on the side with (optional) **tzatziki**.

PARMESAN CHICKEN CUTLETS

WITH SUN-DRIED TOMATO CAESAR SLAW

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Sun-Dried Tomato Vinaigrette (Page 7)³⁴

Casey's Caesar Dressing (Page 9)¹⁴

Bouillon Crouton (Page 10)¹⁴

Parmesan Chicken Cutlets

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast,
sliced in half (lengthwise)

¼ cup All-Purpose Flour

Kosher Salt

1 Egg

½ cup Panko Breadcrumbs

¼ cup grated Parmesan

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

Neutral, High-Smoke Point Oil, *for cooking*

Sun-Dried Tomato Caesar Slaw

Remaining thinly sliced Lacinato Kale

8 Grape Tomatoes, sliced in half

Remaining sliced Romaine Lettuce

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

2 Tbsp Sun-Dried Tomato Vinaigrette

¼ to ½ cup Casey's Caesar Dressing, *plus more to taste*

Shaved Parmesan, *for garnish*

¼ batch (or remaining) Bouillon Crouton

½ of a Lemon, cut into wedges

Instructions

Assemble the Cutlets

1. Pat the **chicken breast** dry with a paper towel before placing it in a shallow bowl. In the same shallow bowl, coat the chicken with **flour** and a pinch of **salt**.
2. In a separate shallow bowl, whisk the **egg**; in a final shallow bowl, combine **panko**, **parmesan**, a generous pinch of salt, and **pepper**.
3. Coat the chicken breasts in flour, then place in the egg mixture, fully coating both sides. Transfer the egg-coated chicken breast into the breadcrumb-parmesan mixture, pressing the breadcrumbs onto the surface of the chicken.
4. Heat enough **neutral oil** to cover the bottom of a large cast-iron skillet over medium heat (*oil filling ¼ inch up the side of the pan preferred*).
5. Once the oil reaches 375°F to 400°F, add chicken cutlets. Cook cutlets on both sides until golden brown and crispy, around 3 to 4 minutes per side. Once the internal temperature of the chicken reaches 165°F, transfer each cutlet to a paper towel-lined plate and season with a pinch of salt.
6. Allow the chicken to rest for 3-4 minutes before serving. *In the meantime, prepare the sun-dried tomato caesar slaw.*

Prepare the Sun-Dried Tomato Caesar Slaw

1. In a medium mixing bowl, combine **kale**, **tomatoes**, **romaine**, **salt**, **pepper**, **sun-dried tomato vinaigrette**, and **Caesar dressing** (add enough to fully coat the greens). Toss until well combined.
2. Plate the chicken cutlet and top with the sun-dried tomato caesar slaw. Garnish with **shaved parmesan**, freshly ground black pepper, **bouillon croutons**, and **lemon wedges** for squeezing.

SUN-DRIED TOMATO GNOCCHI WITH PARMESAN MEATBALLS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Parmesan Meatballs (Page 14)^s

Sun-Dried Tomato Velouté (Page 13)^s

Sun-Dried Tomato Pasta

1 batch of Sun-Dried Tomato Velouté

1 batch of Parmesan Meatballs

1 to 2 Tbsp Chicken or Vegetable Stock (Optional)

Kosher Salt

1 lb of Potato Gnocchi

8 Grape Tomatoes, sliced in half

¼ cup grated Parmesan, *plus shavings for garnish*

Chopped Parsley, *for garnish*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *for garnish*

Instructions

Prepare Gnocchi & Sauce

1. Bring a large pot of water up to a boil.
2. Place the **sun-dried tomato velouté** and **parmesan meatballs** in a saucepan over medium-high heat and bring the sauce to a light boil. Once the sauce is lightly bubbling on the sides of the pan, reduce the heat to low and stir. Cook just until the meatballs are fully reheated.

Hot Tip: If the sauce appears too thick, stir in **1 to 2 tbsp of stock**—the sauce should be the same thickness as gravy or a quality queso.

3. Season the boiling water with a **generous pinch of salt**, then add the **gnocchi**. Cook according to package instructions, likely around 2 minutes.
4. Stir the **halved tomatoes, grated parmesan**, and cooked gnocchi into the sun-dried tomato velouté and add a small pinch of salt.
5. Plate the gnocchi and garnish with **shaved parmesan, chopped parsley**, and a few cracks of **freshly ground black pepper**.

LEMON OREGANO MARINADE

Makes about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup + 2 Tbsp (78 g) Olive Oil
Juice of 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ Lemons (52 g)
2 cloves of Garlic (7-8 g)
1 Tbsp (2 g) Dried Oregano
1 Tbsp (15 g) Sun-Dried Tomato Oil
2 tsp (10 g) Worcestershire Sauce
1 tsp (4 g) Kosher Salt
1 tsp (4 g) White Sugar

Instructions

1. In a blender, combine **all ingredients** and blend until smooth.

To Store: Transfer the marinade to an airtight container and store in the refrigerator.

SUN-DRIED TOMATO VINAIGRETTE

Makes about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup + 1 Tbsp (68 g) Olive Oil
2 Tbsp + 1 tsp (32 g) Red Wine Vinegar
2 Tbsp (30 g) Sun-Dried Tomatoes
2 Tbsp (20 g) Sun-Dried Tomato Oil
2 cloves of Garlic (7 to 8 g)
1 Tbsp + 1 tsp (28 g) Honey
1 Tbsp (15 g) Tomato Paste
1 Tbsp (8 g) grated Parmesan
1 Tbsp (5 g) chopped Parsley
1 tsp (5 g) Dijon Mustard
 $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp (<1 g) Dried Oregano
3 (1") Ice Cubes

Instructions

1. In a blender, combine **all ingredients** and blend until smooth.

To Store: Transfer the vinaigrette to an airtight container and store in the refrigerator.

SILKY HUMMUS

ADAPTED FROM “WHAT CAN I BRING” BY CASEY ELSASS

Makes 1 heaping cup

Ingredients

Juice of 1 Lemon (1 ½ Tbsp Lemon Juice)
1 clove of Garlic
1 (15.5-ounce) can Chickpeas, drained & rinsed
1 tsp Kosher Salt, *divided*
¼ tsp Baking Soda
¼ tsp Ground Cumin
2 cups Water
¼ cup Tahini
1 Ice Cube (*the secret to extra-fluffy hummus*)

Instructions

1. Pour the **lemon juice** into a small bowl. Grate the **garlic clove** directly in the bowl and set aside.
2. Pour the **chickpeas** into a colander. Rinse the chickpeas with cold water while shaking the colander until the cloudy foamy water washes off and the water is totally clear. (If your sink has a hose, now is the perfect time to use it.) Shake the colander again to drain, then pour the chickpeas into a large saucepan. Add ½ **tsp of the salt**, the **baking soda**, **cumin**, and **water**.
3. Set over high heat until boiling, then reduce to medium-low and set a timer for 20 minutes. No need to stir or cover, just let them simmer away. When the timer goes off, carefully scoop out **1 tablespoon of the chickpea water** and set that aside. Pour the chickpeas back into the colander to drain and let them sit for about 10 minutes until they're cool enough to handle.

Hot Tip: This is where it gets a smidge tedious, but just for a moment! It's worth it if you want to put in the effort, but the world will not stop turning if you skip it.

4. Scoop up a handful of chickpeas. Pinch off the skin of each one. Skins go in the trash; naked chickpea in a food processor. (*If some skins end up in the processor, totally fine. Don't sacrifice a finger for the cause.*) Hold a small mesh strainer over the food processor and pour the lemon juice through, discarding the garlic. Add that **reserved chickpea water** along with the **tahini**, **ice cubes**, and remaining ½ **tsp of salt**.
5. Puree the mixture for 2 minutes until it's broken down into a gorgeously thick mixture. Use a rubber spatula to scrape down the sides and taste for seasoning. Then process for 2 more minutes, until it's unbelievably silky smooth.

To Store: Transfer to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

CASEY'S CAESAR DRESSING

ADAPTED FROM “WHAT CAN I BRING” BY CASEY ELSASS

Makes about 1 ⅓ cups

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Silky Hummus (Page 8)²³

½ cup Silky Hummus

Juice of 1 Lemon

2 Garlic Cloves

¼ cup grated Parmesan Cheese

2 Tbsp Capers

2 tsp Caper Brine

2 Tbsp Extra-Virgin Olive Oil

2 Tbsp Dijon Mustard

4 tsp Soy Sauce or Tamari

2 Ice Cubes

2 tsp Freshly Ground Black Pepper

1 tsp Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. In a blender, combine—in this order—the **hummus, lemon juice, garlic cloves, parmesan, capers** and **brine**, the **olive oil** and **Dijon mustard, soy sauce, ice cubes, pepper**, and **salt**.

Hot Tip: Add the oil and mustard in alternating tablespoons so the mustard slides out

2. Blend on high until the ice cubes go silent and the dressing is completely smooth, about 1 minute.
3. It's great now, but it's better later, so pour it into an airtight container and refrigerate.

To Store: Once completely cooled, transfer to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

BOUILLON CROUTONS

ADAPTED FROM “WHAT CAN I BRING” BY CASEY ELSASS

Makes about 5 cups of croutons

Ingredients

1 (16-ounce) Loaf Soft Italian or French Bread,
gluten-free if you want
1/4 cup Extra-Virgin Olive Oil
1 Tbsp Vegetable or Chicken Bouillon Paste,
like Better Than Bouillon

Instructions

1. Preheat the oven to 450°F. Line a rimmed baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Tear the **bread** into roughly 1-inch pieces with irregular edges. Arrange the croutons on the prepared baking sheet. In a small bowl, whisk the **olive oil** and **bouillon** together, then drizzle it over the croutons and toss to coat.
3. Slide the baking sheet into the oven and set a timer for 4 minutes. Flip the croutons over, then set a timer for 4 more minutes. At this point they should be a little crunchy on the surface but soft inside. Give them 2 more minutes if you think they need it, then set aside to cool on the baking sheet.

To Store: Place cooled-down croutons in an air-tight container and store in a cool dark place for later use.

FLUFFY PITA

ADAPTED FROM “WHAT CAN I BRING” BY CASEY ELSASS

Makes 8 pitas

Ingredients

2 $\frac{3}{4}$ cups (385 grams) Unbleached Bread Flour*, *divided*
1 (0.25-ounce) packet Instant Yeast
1 Tbsp Honey or Sugar
1 cup Warm Water
1 Tbsp Extra-Virgin Olive Oil, plus more for the bowl
2 tsp Kosher Salt

Instructions

Make the Dough

1. In the bowl of a stand mixer, whisk together **$\frac{3}{4}$ cup (105 grams) flour**, the **yeast, honey**, and **1 cup (230 grams) warm tap water**. Fit the dough hook to the mixer and add the **olive oil** and another **1 cup (140 grams) flour** to the mixer bowl. Mix on low speed until a sticky dough forms, about 2 minutes. Scrape down the sides, then add the **salt** and the remaining **1 cup (140 grams) flour**. Start mixing on low to get the flour incorporated, then increase the speed to high and set a timer for 5 minutes. The dough should be smooth, a little sticky, and the sides of the bowl should be clean.
2. Lift the dough up, drizzle a little olive oil in the bowl, and plop the dough back in. Cover the bowl tightly with plastic wrap and put it in a warm place to rise. Set a timer for 1 hour and take a break. By the time you come back the dough should be beautifully puffy and doubled in size. If not, set a timer for 30 minutes and check again.
3. Lightly dust half the counter with flour. Punch the dough down and scrape it out onto the floured side of the counter. Pat it into a rough rectangle and use a knife or a bench scraper to cut the dough into 8 equal pieces. With each piece, create a smooth ball by tucking the edges under. Set the ball on the unfloured side of the counter, seam side down, and lightly cup your hand over it with your thumb and pinkie firmly on the counter. Roll, using the heel of your hand, thumb, and pinkie as barriers against the ball, then place the ball back on the floured side. Keep rolling and space the balls about 2 inches apart on the counter.
4. Sprinkle a little more flour on top of the balls and cover loosely with plastic wrap. Set a timer for 30 minutes.

Prepare the Fluffy Pitas

1. Preheat the oven to 500°F and set a rack in the lowest position. Set an upside-down baking sheet or a baking stone on the rack to preheat.
2. Lightly dust the other side of the counter with more flour. Working one at a time, remove a ball and use your palm to press it flat into a small circle. (Keep the other balls covered until it's their turn.) Grab a rolling pin or wine bottle and roll into a rough and imperfect 5-inch circle, dusting with more flour to prevent any sticking. Roll out 2 of the balls, then set a timer for 10 minutes to let them air dry. Roll out 2 more balls while those are resting and let them start drying.
3. When the timer goes off, roll out the last 4 balls and let them dry out. Slide the low rack out and lift the first two circles on the preheated sheet. Immediately shut the oven and set a timer for 2 minutes. Use a wide spatula to flip the pitas and bake for 2 more minutes just so the bottoms can brown. Immediately remove and wrap in a thick kitchen towel to keep warm. Continue baking the rest of the pitas in the order that you rolled them.

TZATZIKI

Makes roughly 1 cup

Ingredients

2 Persian Cucumbers, grated & pressed*
1 cup (230 g) Greek Yogurt
2 Tbsp (7 g) finely chopped Dill
1 Tbsp (7 g) Olive Oil
1 clove (5 g) Garlic, grated
Juice of ¼ of a Lemon (or 1 Lemon Wedge)
¾ tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt

*to press, take 1-2 paper towels and gently press against the grated cucumber to extract excess moisture.

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a mixing bowl and whisk until thoroughly combined.

To Store: Place the marinade in an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator.

SUN-DRIED TOMATO VELOUTÉ

Makes about 2 cups

Ingredients

3 Tbsp (42 g) Salted Butter
1 Tbsp Olive Oil
1 Shallot, finely diced or thinly sliced
2 cloves of Garlic, grated
2 Tbsp All-Purpose Flour
1 ½ cups Chicken or Vegetable Stock
3 Tbsp Sun-Dried Tomatoes
¾ tsp Kosher Salt, *plus more to season in layers*

Instructions

1. Melt **butter** in a medium saucepan over medium-high heat. Once the butter is almost melted, add **olive oil**, **shallot**, and a pinch of **salt**—sauté for about 1 ½ to 2 minutes or until the shallot is mostly translucent.
2. Stir in the **grated garlic** and cook for 10 seconds, *just until fragrant* (we do not want to burn the garlic).
3. Whisk in the **flour** and cook for about 1 minute, forming a roux.
4. Whisk in the **stock**, **sun-dried tomatoes**, and ¾ **tsp salt**—bring the heat up to high.
5. Cook, whisking frequently, until the velouté has significantly thickened (*it should be thick enough to fully coat the back of a spoon*).
6. Transfer the velouté to a blender or an immersion blender-friendly vessel (like a deli container). Blend until smooth and silky. Taste and add salt, if needed.

To Store: Once the sauce has cooled completely, place it in an airtight container and store in the refrigerator.

PARMESAN MEATBALLS

Makes about 16 x 1 ½" meatballs (or 9 to 10 x 2" meatballs)

Ingredients

Olive Oil
1 Shallot, finely diced
2 cloves of Garlic, grated
¼ tsp Onion Powder
¼ tsp Garlic Powder
¼ cup Panko Breadcrumbs
1 Egg
½ cup Grated Parmesan
1 tsp Kosher Salt, *plus more to season in layers*
½ lb (8 oz) Ground Meat (Ground Chicken, Pork, or Beef)

Instructions

1. Heat a few glugs of **olive oil** in a sauté pan over medium heat. Once the oil is hot, add the **diced shallot** and a pinch of **salt**. Once the shallot is translucent, about 1-2 minutes, add the **grated garlic** and stir. Once the garlic is fragrant, after about 15-20 seconds of cooking, turn off the heat and transfer the sautéed shallot and garlic to a large mixing bowl.
2. To the same bowl, add **onion powder, garlic powder, breadcrumbs, egg, parmesan**, and **1 tsp salt**. Stir until well combined, then add the **ground meat** and mix well.
3. Heat a thin layer of olive oil in a large skillet over high heat.
 1. Using a small spoon or a 1 ½" (.5 oz) cookie scoop, scoop out small rounds of the meat mixture and place directly into the hot oil.
 2. Cook for about 2-3 minutes per side until golden brown and crispy on all sides.
 3. Once the internal temperature of the largest meatball reaches 165°F, transfer the meatballs to a paper towel-lined plate.

To Store: Allow the meatballs to come to room temperature before transferring them to an airtight container. *If you're consuming them within 4 days*, store them in the refrigerator for optimal freshness; *for 4+ days*, store them in the freezer.